Fuller Joint Faculty Luncheon
Remarks on Findings of World Inquiry: Mission as Transformation

Luis Bush

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A Word of Thanks to Fuller

I thank God for the Fuller sponsorship of and partnership in the World Inquiry. It was conducted in more than 110 cities with about 6,500 Christian leaders who came from more than 800 different cities to participate in those events. Fuller provided substantial support over the entire duration of the project. That support has come mainly in the form of the time and commitment of faculty at their own expense.

1. Our provost, Sherwood Lingenfelter, for example, personally conducted world inquiries in Africa—in Nairobi; in South Asia—in Chennai, India; and in New York, at the Christian and Missionary Alliance Seminary.
2. Several SIS faculty members met early in the process to discuss key issues related to world evangelization and how to organize them into categories. That effort contributed to the formulation of the 31 issues for the upcoming Lausanne-sponsored Issues Forum. The wording of the categories of these issues comes from the hand of Wilbert Shenk, who is also serving as the chief editor of the outcomes of the Issues Forum. The World Inquiry was conducted in collaboration with the Lausanne Committee for World Evangelization (Please see **Appendix A**). The results will be presented verbally and in five or six books by authors from different regions around the world. Paul Pierson is writing one of the books titled *From Periphery: Emerging Streams of Church and Mission*.
3. Viggo Sogaard carefully reviewed and edited the Quantitative and Qualitative World Inquiry survey instrument to ensure that it conformed to the high standards he demands. He will be compiling, organizing, analyzing, and presenting the final results in a book titled *Evangelizing our World: Insights from Global Inquiry*.
4. We held a mid-course assessment with 120 international leaders who formed a World Inquiry International Coalition in Seoul Korea in May 2003 to review the preliminary findings. Paul Pierson, Dudley Woodberry, and Wilbert Shenk were actively involved in that event.
5. Roberta King provided her materials and insights on how to facilitate focus groups.
6. Bobby Clinton encouraged us along this journey, as did other faculty members and students in SIS, particularly Ph.D. student Peter Lee who has taken a significant role in the implementation process.

   Wendy Walker found a place for us to hold the World Inquiry of the Korean leaders from the Los Angeles area, hosted by faculty member Timothy Park.

World Inquiry Beginnings

The first Inquiry was held over a weeklong period in July 2001 with Mayan tribal leaders in Chiapas, Mexico—an invitation that came through Chuck Van Engen who with Jean had served as missionaries in this area.

The need to listen to hear what God was saying to His people began in my own heart in August of 2000, upon receiving the following e-mail from Paul McKaughan, President of the Evangelical Fellowship of Mission Agencies:

> I do not know of any time in my 35 years of mission experience that I have seen or felt mission executives more ready and willing to change and adapt. At the same time, I also don't know of any period in my career that there is less certainty about what changes to make. The future is uncertain. We know it will be greatly different but are not sure in which ways it will be different. We know that the patterns of the past are showing "wear" and require need repair. In many ways, our strategies and way of thinking do not fit our present reality well. We know that they probably won't move us into the future God has for us. Yet the new paradigms that help us interpret and organize our strategies for the future have not become clear.

The interest in going on "the journey of the listening mode" was further enhanced during the final months of the year 2000. An abiding question in my mind was: *Where do we go from here in world evangelization?* The encouragement of my 15-year accountability/support group led me to reflect on this question a doctoral study here at Fuller under the active and able oversight of Wilbert Shenk, Chuck Van Engen, and Sherwood Lingenfelter.

While looking through the lenses of the Scriptures, theology, missiology, church history, global mission conferences, the AD2000 Movement, and Christian leadership—it became clear that the focus of the dissertation would more appropriately be on informing the question, rather than seeking to provide answers.

World Inquiry Purpose

And so, began a journey to look for expressions of *Missio Dei*[1] (the mission of God).[2] We sought to listen to what God is doing and saying by collecting insights, beliefs, and attitudes concerning:

- The people and the programs God is using;
- The external challenges to God's mission;
- The internal obstacles within the Church;
- What God is calling us to as the body of Christ;
- The identification of emerging leaders, and streams of church and mission; and
- The identification of a compelling, unifying paradigm.

World Inquiry Process

The World Inquiry process can be described in a story from the lips of Richard Howell, the General Secretary of the Evangelical Fellowship of India. The story came in the context of Richard waiting for a delayed flight from Calcutta to go to the thirteenth major city inquiry in India on Jan 22, 2003.

- The Inquiry process, starting January 6, 2003, to the present day, has confirmed God's timing.
- I have seen this to be the timing of God for India.
- Personally, the different streams have converged in my life through the Inquiry process to give me a more integrated view of ministry, in my personal life and at a conceptual level.
- It has clarified how to implement the vision.
- It has also shown me there is no need for polarities that are man-made primarily because our vision is small.
- If the vision is of God and His Kingdom, then the process of renewing is unleashed.
- God has opened my eyes to something very wonderful—His Kingdom—which I have preached before and struggled over in the past.
- The unfolding of it will still take time—but the journey for me has begun.
- Looking back, I can interpret recent ministerial developments, talking to people of other faiths, relationships with ecumenical, and Catholics—this process has helped to interpret the meaning of these developments.
- There is a personal renewal deep down. God has touched the core of my being.
- It was seeing what happened in the inquiries in Ludhiana, then Chandigarh, where I became a convert to this.
- It got a hold of me. It came from people. The baby was born. It has been one reconfirmation after another.
- The day before yesterday, it was Serrampore, at the college that William Carey founded.
- There were 50 involved in the Inquiry including the Principal, VP, faculty of the seminary, pastors, and Christian leaders in the community, and the graduating class of the seminary.
- The principal kept saying, "This is the kind of meeting I had been hoping to have for a long time."
- Amazingly, with such a varied group present, in part because of the minority they are as Christians in the Serampore city, a definitive city-based initiative birthed with a vision statement, mission statement, and core group, including representation of all the constituencies present at the meeting.
- Yesterday we had the Kolkata event despite the visit of the President of India into the city.
- Several of the key leaders had indicated they were going to stay for one half-day.
- In the end, they stayed through to 4 p.m., and with deep conviction, a city-based initiative was birthed with ten in the core group.
- It is the birthing of a vision for cities that will bring focus and integration for doing missions in the cities.
- It will be a movement of transformation that will bring the various streams together in partnership to impact the cities and the nation.
- It is the mission in the cities that will also have a ripple effect on the towns and villages.

- I am excited, really excited, for the impact on the evangelical movement—and more so because the ecumenical church is looking to the evangelical church for the spiritual vitality to transform the ecumenical churches and leadership itself.
- So, what I am talking about is that this new movement will lead to renewal.
- When I say "it is birthing," I refer to the Inquiry process which is bringing together a wide range of Christian leadership in the cities; and the initiative is birthing in the broader base of the Christian church in India.
- The need for transformation, the need for vision and united prayer, has been stated in the Inquiry focus groups.
- The issue is not only the transformation of the city as the goal; it's the transformation of the church going on at the same time.
- The church in India is all saying it needs transformation, and what is emerging has the potential of bringing dramatic transformation to the church.
- The vision is broadening the base of church/mission leader involvement, while at the same time calling for and igniting a spirit of renewal.
- It is not only the city and the church that needs transformation—it is the Christian leader and his family and other Christians that do.

World Inquiry Finding: Mission as Transformation:
a Compelling, Unifying Emerging Paradigm

A compelling and unifying paradigm for mission has emerged which is: "Mission as transformation." Some of the World Inquiry results related specifically to the emerging paradigm of mission as transformation include the following:

- As we listened to one another and sought God through His Word to hear what the Spirit was saying to the church, we saw streams of church and mission emerging on the periphery of mainline ecclesiastical and mission structures; and we shared the visions on the hearts of God's servants.
- Five major transformational streams are flowing across the world: the revivalist stream, the church growth stream, the city-reaching stream, the stream engaged in the transformational development of the poor, and the marketplace redemption stream.
- The revivalist stream emphasizes **divine visitation and revival**. God acts on the Church bringing revival, and He acts on society bringing spiritual awakening. What is taking place in Fiji today is an example of this transformational stream. There are 60 transformation venues in Fiji alone. Tribal leaders are being reconciled. Denominational leaders have coalesced in heart, mind, and vision. The Prime Minister begins the day early seeking God. The governmental cabinet seeks to do what is right. The restorative work of God is even becoming evident in nature itself through regenerating coral reefs.
- The church growth stream refers to **church planting movements**. Working in a spirit of cooperation, resulting in healthy churches in every class and kind of people, and within practical and relational reach of every person—these movements are permeating every segment of society with the love, truth, and saving power of Jesus Christ.

- The **city-reaching stream** emphasizes strategizing to reach a city in obedience to God as an apostolic people with an apostolic mission to transform peoples, places, and the culture within which the Church lives.[3] Mission Houston is a good model of this. (Please see **Appendix B**.)
- **Transformational development of the poor** through community development. This involves creating a better future for the poor.[4]
- **Pioneer marketplace redemption**. The marketplace—the combination of business, education, and government—in many ways constitutes the heart of a nation. By using Kingdom principles, believers gain authority over cities. This principle is found in Jesus' parable of the Minas (Luke 19:10-27).[5]

While each of the five transformational streams has distinct approaches, there are some common strands, as Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden remind us. "An effort to define a comprehensive approach to transformation must be "rooted in the theology of the mission of the Kingdom of God and seeks to express the Lordship of Jesus over every aspect of life, economic, religious, personal, and political. It does not give priority to any area of life as an area for mission . . . but this change will be effected whenever people address issues of life directly, rooted in a gospel perspective."[6]

All five lenses used in the World Inquiry process showed that *mission as transformation* has emerged as a new, compelling, unifying paradigm at the beginning of the twenty-first century. *Mission as transformation* is built upon four foundational pillars of truth. First, we are living in a fallen, deformed world needing to be transformed; second, individuals are being called to be conformed to the image of Christ; third, churches are being challenged to be renewed and reformed to align with God's greater purposes; and fourth, cities, communities, peoples, and nations are being transformed.

The Meaning of Transformation as Mission

This brings us to the question: What is transformation? There are several descriptions and various expressions of what transformation is all about. Each description emphasizes certain aspects of transformation which are often associated with one of the five major streams.

The Transformational Stream Nuances the Meaning

The city-reaching stream transformation refers to two points of time in a city's history—where the city is now and where it once was. For a growing number of cities, the language that best describes the degree of societal change occurring between those two historic points is transformation. Deep and profound change is possible in human beings and is equally possible for the social organisms that we call cities and communities.[7]

For the **revivalists,** sometimes called transformation associates, who are now gathering to contemplate and then seek to cooperate with the beauty of God's movements, the basic idea behind "transformation coordination" is that not only can we do more together than we can separately, but we move to a new ministry realm which operates on entirely new godly laws of

input and output. Like the gushing forth of the waters, the love of God through the people of God unleashes multiple mission initiatives in which divine resources are channeled through willing servants to meet human needs to the glory of God.

For the **transformational development of the poor stream** through community development, transformation involves seeking positive change in the whole of human life materially, socially, and spiritually, by recovering our true identity as human beings created in the image of God and discovering our true vocation as productive stewards, faithfully caring for our world and people.[8]

The Context Often Colors the Meaning

In Africa, the transformation movement relates primarily to annual transformation prayer days. On May 2, 2004, an estimated 20 million people in 52 countries met in more than 1200 African stadiums, as God's people came together for several hours of fervent, united prayer. There were 58 reported events in Egypt alone, 1,000 in Nigeria, and another 1,000 in Ghana. A week of bounty preceded the prayer day in Africa as God's people gave generously to bless communities, cities, and nations. Event co-patron Michael Cassidy declared: "We need to get with what the Lord is doing and move from prayer in the stadiums to transformation of the cities."

The full essence of transformation incorporates personal, corporate, and societal dimensions as in the following example. Transformation is the progressive and ongoing, measurable, supernatural impact of the presence and power of God working in, through, and apart from the Church on human society and structures. In the Church, this is characterized by increased holiness of life, reconciliation in relationships, and appetite for prayer and worship. Through the Church, this is characterized by accelerated conversion growth, mobilization of gifts and callings, and an increased relevance to and participation in greater society. In the culture, this may be characterized by pervasive awareness of the reality of God, a radical correction of social ills, a commensurate decrease in crime rates, supernatural blessing on local commerce, healing of the brokenhearted (the alienated and disenfranchised), regenerative acts of restoring the productivity of the land, and an exporting of kingdom righteousness.[9]

Transform World: Indonesia 2005 and Subsequent Annual Networking Events

One of the specific outcomes of this has been initiatives by respected Christian leaders from Asia, Africa, and Latin America to organize major networking events around the themes of transformation—the first being held in Indonesia on May 1-5, 2005 and called "Transform World: Indonesia 2005."

Transform World: Indonesia 2005 seeks to connect worldwide servants of God engaged in significant transformational ministries, to commune with God and one another, that a growing community might arise to collaborate with God's mission of transformation.

Twenty to 25 focus groups will construct ways and means to empower city and national transformational initiatives. For example, the health focus group core leadership team is well underway in creating a global health network currently expressing their mission as transforming nations through the seamless combination of disease prevention and community-based development.

Internationals coming to Indonesia will seek to learn from and celebrate the national transformational initiatives and bless the nation in different ways. For 15 years, a growing prayer network in Indonesia has being praying for transformation. Inter-church, inter-mission groups are functioning in more than 350 cities, coordinating concerts of prayer for transformation. They have designated 2005 the year of transformation for Indonesia. The closing meeting is planned for the largest stadium in Indonesia—with a climactic time of prayer for transformation.

When Christian leaders (most of them participants in the World Inquiry findings event in Seoul in May 2003) saw this emerging transformational stream (like those from India indicated), they were interested in hosting a global event similar to Indonesia. They have planned Transform World: India 2006, Korea 2007, Brazil 2008, Africa 2009—and so on, through 2011.

The transformation paradigm is a post-modern paradigm of mission. It fits in Europe. It suits the Hip-Hop culture well. Younger leaders are connecting to the streams and the network events.

How can Fuller Faculty and Students Engage in this New Mission Thrust of the Church Around the World?

All three schools of Fuller can become directly involved. The first step is to Transform World: Indonesia 2005. Already several faculty and students have indicated their commitment. Others are still thinking about it. There are several possible roles in this working conference. Faculty members can serve as advisors/consultants or as facilitators or in a dialogue in an email conference for anyone of the focus groups (See Focus Groups List in Appendix C).

Faculty and students already involved in Transform World: Indonesia 2005 include the following:

- Wilbert Shenk – chair of the Transformational Covenant Committee made up of the chairpersons of each of the focus groups
- Evelyn Reisacher – a facilitator for the Other Religions Focus Group. which will spotlight Islam
- Remi Lawanson – a TA and studying for his Ph.D. – chair of the Mission Focus Group whose function is to construct a missiological framework for "mission as transformation."
- Farida Saidi – studying for her Ph.D., is chair of the Other Religions Group to construct a missiological framework for "mission as transformation."
- Bill Dyrness – advisor/consultant in the Theology Focus Group
- Sherwood Lingenfelter – advisor/consultant in Culture and Transformation
- Dan Shaw is facilitating connection with Ph.D. students and the Transformation Process

Some Concluding Observations:

Among the most interesting movements in the churches around the world is a growing commitment for engagement of church and culture with the goal of biblical transformation.

The current articulation of the Transform World: Indonesia 2005 vision is: To see all nations redeemed and restored, with cultures reflecting the value system of the Kingdom of God—now and in the future—that the power, the presence, and the peace of God be experienced by all.

What seems to be emerging is an exercise in "Christ transforming culture." The question is: how can the body of Christ be the arms and hands and feet of the head of the body, the Lord Jesus Christ, on His mission of transformation?

Richard Mouw's article "Christianity and Culture: A Challenge for the New China,"[10] develops the nature of the challenge and the call for transformation that resonates with that which is emerging out of the World Inquiry findings.

Imagine for a moment a transformed world is a place where the power, the presence, and the peace of God are experienced by all. The power of God is unleashed. The peace of God rules. Shalom-Salaam embrace. The presence of God fills the earth. "Love and faithfulness meet together; righteousness and peace kiss each other. Faithfulness springs forth from the earth, and righteousness looks down from heaven" (Ps. 85:10-11).

I invite to join us in prayer for the September 7 and 8 huddle of representative Christian leaders in London for the express purpose of "linking continents around the transformation movement for a time of sharing and seeking God for a united response of the body to the head of the Church, the Lord Jesus."

For me the experience of the World Inquiry can best be described in the words of John Stott when he said: "Life is a pilgrimage of learning, a voyage of discovery, in which our mistaken views are corrected, our distorted notions adjusted, our shallow opinions deepened, and some of our vast ignorances diminished."[11]

Appendix A
1974: Lausanne I and the Vital Support Role of Fuller
Provides an Historical Context for the World Inquiry

- By the late 1960's, a movement among evangelicals arose that led to the International Congress on World Evangelization held in Lausanne in 1974. The late David Hubbard and Donald McGavran of Fuller were catalysts of this new movement, particularly as a result of the prophetic role they had in The Geneva Conference on Church and Society in 1966 and in relation to Uppsala '68, respectively. They were concerned that: "Humanization seemed to replace evangelization as the goal of mission." On the other hand, as Fuller President Richard Mouw has said: "Fuller Theological Seminary actually came into existence in 1947 in order to reform or modify the patterns of Protestant fundamentalism" as historian George Marsden observed in his book *Reforming Fundamentalism, Fuller Seminary in the New Evangelicalism*.[10]
- This new movement among evangelicals was building to recover both the vertical and horizontal dimensions of the gospel, and Fuller was playing a lead role as noted by Alister McGrath, a respected British scholar at Oxford, in his book *The Christianity of the Future*, published two years ago. In it, he signaled Billy Graham as the figurehead and Fuller as one of the two leading institutions in evangelicalism in the United States. Quoting historian George Marsden, he wrote that they became ". . . flagships of the new movement, which moved rapidly to gain momentum and influence."
- In the face of racism and poverty, it was recognized that a full-orbed gospel was required if evangelization was to be credible. Work began at Fuller in support of Lausanne I. Now, once again for this upcoming fourth major Lausanne event, Fuller is providing strong support.
- The major contributions of the Lausanne Movement include, first, the Lausanne Covenant which brought together the major streams within evangelicalism and consolidated a theological and missiological consensus. In so doing, Lausanne, secondly, spawned multiple events in which Christian leaders collaborated together to pray, reflect, and plan for evangelization; and thirdly, Lausanne catalyzed new initiatives of evangelization.

2001: Lausanne Leaders Meet Fuller Faculty

In May 2001, the leadership team of Lausanne, led by Chairman Paul Cedar, who at one time taught at Fuller, met with SIS faculty to discuss the upcoming Lausanne event. Called the *2004 Forum for World Evangelization*, it is to take place September 29 to October 5, in Pattaya, Thailand. It was that Lausanne/SIS interchange three years ago that resulted in the three-way connection between Fuller, the World Inquiry, and Lausanne. Fuller sponsored the World Inquiry, providing advice at various stages of the research, design, and conduct of the inquiry process and assessment. The Inquiry was conducted in collaboration with the Lausanne Committee on World Evangelization, with a view to a presentation of the findings at the 2004 Issues Forum.

Appendix B
Mission Houston is a Case Study of City Transformation

In a unique country-to-city prayer-partnership, hundreds of thousands of Christians in Indonesia committed in 2002 to be interceding for Mission Houston. Perhaps this is why Mission Houston has become an example of the spiritual ethos, operational principles, and resulting impact on the Christian leaders, their churches, and ministries, and increasingly the communities and businesses of the city of 4.5 million.

Mission Houston was born in 1998 through the efforts of Jim Herrington with Steve Capper. The transformational process models:

1. Vision casting: Helping the whole body of Christ in Houston embrace a vision of focusing its resources on reaching its communities by means of establishing leadership teams who are deeply committed to one another and the mission of transforming their communities.

2. Researching: Mission Houston's research arm, Houston Profile Project (HPP), divided the city and surrounding metro area into 45 community study areas (CSA's) to cultivate transformation. They are creating group narratives of the various international people groups in the city, describing their worldview and cultural characteristics.

3. Interceding: Mission Houston's intercession arm, Houston Prays, catalyzes and coordinates fervent focused prayer with over 300 prayer networks, through prayer summits centered around the mission of seeing the church unified and mobilized to touch every people group and community in this city as a lifelong calling.

4. Leadership development: Leaders Edge has welcomed over 200 leaders into an intensive process that introduces the foundational paradigms of "transformation" and provides needed skills and effective ministry models for implementing those paradigms.

5. Creating missional Christian community in workplaces by identifying transformation movements of God in the places where people work, and by sharing ministry models.

6. Church planning movements through serving as consultants in church planting initiatives.

7. Social action by enacting high leverage opportunities to minister together to the community through acts of service and kindness, especially to the poor and oppressed.

Laura Sorrell, a volunteer on Mission Houston's research staff concludes her report: "We believe that God is creating a ground swell of support to reach the City both Top-down and Bottom-up."

Appendix C
Focus Groups for Transform World: Indonesia 2005

? Awaiting a Decision

Focus Group Name	Description	Facilitator	Chairman
Art		Julie Spence	
Church	The role of the church in society		
City	Systematic study of God's activity in citywide initiatives around the world has enabled leaders to delineate principles, describe processes, and discover practices to increase the Church's effectiveness in transforming cities. God's pathway to revival and visitation and his passageway to spiritual, societal and structural change have become clearer. When interwoven effectively these elements form an overall strategy that guides the formation and healthy development of our collective and collaborative effort to bring dramatic and unprecedented change to the city.	Jack Dennison	
Culture	To see all nations redeemed and restored, with cultures reflecting the value system of the Kingdom of God.	Darrow Miller?	
Discipleship	umans created in the image of God long with all of creation to be estored to liberated life that was lost with the entrance of sin into this orld. Transformational biblical discipleship is grounded in a ersonal, costly relationship with a seeking Savior, begins with and trives toward a transformed identity in Jesus, is initiated and mpowered by the Spirit of God, is guided daily and consistently by od's Word, is developed through a whole-life, life-long process of ecoming more fully transformed into the image of Christ, is nurtured communities of faith, and is carried out by sojourning in and itnessing to the watching world. The individual transformation of esus' disciples establishes the only realistic hope of transformation f the cities, nations, and the world.	Richard Howell	Michael Cassidy
Education		Elizabeth Youmans?	
Family			
Governance			
Health	Transforming nations through the seamless combination of disease prevention, evangelism, and community-based development.	Stan Rowland & Clydette Powell	Vinod Shah
Information		David Hamilton	
Leadership		Rickie Bradsaw	
Least Reached Peoples	The "Least Reached" focus group will focus on population segments among which there is no indigenous community of believing Christians with adequate numbers and resources to evangelize their own population segment. Given Jesus' command to disciple the ethne, the base structure to consider will be people groups. However, other biblical realities call upon us to also focus upon tribes, clans,	Stan Parks	

	languages, nations, cities, communities.		
Market Place		Ed Silvoso	Graham Power?
Media		Mark Mclendon	
Nation Building	God chose to establish expressions of humanity through nations as the primary way that people live in community and connect globally. Infrastructures were devised as paths to development. Faith was meant to cross every infrastructure, not become one. Geo-political earthly kingdoms find their highest expression when transcended by the single kingdom of God that rules and reigns within the heart of followers of every nation. That kingdom is established by every believer acting as a priest, not an infrastructure of priest. God's total expression on earth is not seen in any single nation but in all of the nations – each bringing their own unique contribution. The inequity experienced among nations is God's call upon local churches and every believer, not just vocational Christian religious workers to proclaim the Good news of Christ and to feed, clothe, heal, house, and serve. With travel, communication, education, linkage of domains and people like never before, the church has the opportunity, the responsibility, and the hope of literally being players in seeing nations develop holistically. Individual believers transformed using their vocation as their primary ministry to turn the world upside down – just like Acts!	Bob Roberts	
Mission		Eiko Takamizawa	Remi Lawanson
Other Religions		Evelyn Reisacher	Farida Saidi
Poor		Steve Goode?	
Prayer	The overarching objective of the Prayer Focus Group is to understand the necessary components of a sustainable transformational community in a defined geographic locale that is comprised of a diversity of kingdom-minded Christians (one Church, numerous congregations) committed to an on-going journey of relational trust, regular prayer and shared responsibility for the task of discipling the collective souls of that geography. spiritual and social change to that nation, and its neighbors.	Tom White	Iman Santoso
Scriptural Impact	The whole church around the world taking responsibility to see that... Every people group has ready access to the entire Bible in the most appropriate language(s) and media, and are increasingly able to use it effectively - in intercession and worship, evangelism, discipleship, church-planting, works of service, and theological reflection - in this and every generation.	Todd Poulter	
The China Factor			Thomas Wang
Theology			Sang-Bo David Kim
Youth			

Endnotes

1. *missio Dei* was introduced at the Fifth International Missionary Council Meeting in Willingen, Germany in 1952. George Vicedom wrote the first major study of *missio Dei* in 1965. Understanding *missio Dei* helps to understand the heart of God for the world. However, with time the *missio Dei* motif became the expression along which missiological understanding flowed in ever broadening and deepening conceptualizations. *missio Dei* became a dynamic rather than a static concept, adapting to contextual and historical pulsations rather than anchored to a biblical foundation. In using the term in the purpose of inquiry, the conceptualization of *missio Dei* as the pure mission of God is emphasized. Mission has its origin in the fatherly heart of God. God is the protagonist in the mission and every Christian believer is called to become an active participant in *missio Dei.*

2. In using the term *missio Dei,* the emphasis was on the perfectly pure motive and essence of the mission of God, or that which finds its root and foundation in the character of God.

3. Jack Dennison, *City Reaching: On the Road to Community Transformation* (Pasadena, CA: William Carey Library, 1999).

4. Jajakumar Christian, World Vision, India, sees poverty as a set of disempowering systems. There is the biophysical system—body and mind—which represents the basic human needs of health and education. There is the cultural system in terms of inadequacies in worldview. There is the captivity to god-complexes of the non-poor and deception by principalities and powers, promoting anti-life and deception through the religious systems. These all interact and contribute to the disempowerment and marred identity of the poor.

5. Ed Silvoso introduces the concept in November 2004.

6. Vinay Samuel and Chris Sugden, eds., "Introduction," *Mission as Transformation* (Regnum, 1999).

7. Jack Dennison, *CitiReach*.

8. Bryant Myers, World Vision Intl.

9. Tom White, Frontline Ministries.

10. "Christianity and Culture: A Challenge for the New China" [07-01-03]. Dr. Richard J. Mouw, President, Fuller Theological Seminary. This article is a summary of an address delivered at the 8th annual meeting of Chinese Scholars of Christianity and other Religions of China at Fuller Theological Seminary.